

MECHANICS IN WRITING

The main categories of errors which you must avoid to get good marks in essay are

- a. Unavoidable errors in grammar.

- b. Punctuation errors

- c. Spelling errors.

Half a mark ($\frac{1}{2}$) will be deducted for each error. Only if you have up to twenty (20) errors, you will score zero under mechanical accuracy.

Mechanics simply means the techniques involved in

writing - spelling, punctuation, paragraphing, capitalization, bifurcation etc.

a. Errors in Grammar: The omission of an essential sentence element (subject, predicator, complement).

- Wrong tense.

- Misuse of modal operators (may/might, 'can/could) etc.

- Misuse or omission of the article.

- Confusion or ambiguity in the use of pronouns.

- Misuse of countable and uncountable nouns.

- Wrong Prepositions.

- Misuse of relatives, subordinators and conjunctions.

- Errors in concord (agreement).

- Inisrelated Participles.

- Intransitive verb for transitive and vice versa.

- Misuse of Active for passive and vice versa.

- Errors in comparative construction.

b. Punctuation Errors: Avoid the following errors?

- omission or wrong use of full stop, question mark, exclamation mark, quotation marks (errors at the beginning and end of quotation. " " or ' ').